SPECIAL INTENSIVE REVISION 2025-26

India: 13.39 crore names left off the draft rolls

The reasons recorded for removals in each state, who was removed by sex where states published it, and what goes with the removal rate

13,39,02,054 names left off the draft rolls in 31 states and union territories

71.5% of those split by reason entered as shifted, absent or other

21.0% entered as dead

7.6% entered as enrolled more than once

PinPoint Ventures · 6 October 2026

Contents

- In short
- At a glance
- State by state, on one map
- The rolls against the adult population
- The three reasons, by phase
- State by state
- Women among the removed
- What goes with the removal rate
- After the final rolls
- Against the winning margins
- The roll over forty years
- How the revision was run

What the Election Commission should do

Method and sources

In short

1. Before the revision, the rolls already held 98.3% of adults in the 19 states with population projections. Only 6 of those states had more names on the roll than adults.
2. The revision still left 13.39 crore names off the draft rolls, the first published versions of the revised rolls, in 31 states. That is 14.1 of every 100 electors, and the draft rolls now hold 84.4% of adults. States whose rolls were most over-full did not cut more.
3. Where the names removed can be counted seat by seat, in Bihar and Tamil Nadu, they were more than the winning margin, the votes by which the winner beat the runner-up, in 385 of 477 assembly seats. That makes them large enough to have decided those seats, though the lists cannot show that they did. In West Bengal and Kerala only the fall in the roll can be counted, and it was more than the margin in 177 of 434.
4. Of the names removed with a reason given, only 21.0% were entered as dead. The rest are names an officer marked as moved, missing or on the roll twice.
5. The same rules gave very different results. Delhi removed 32.8 of every 100 electors and Lakshadweep 2.5. Among the big states, the share marked moved or not found runs from 49.7% in Andhra Pradesh to 91.1% in Delhi.
6. Women were more likely to be removed. In 7 of the 11 states that report by sex, women are a bigger share of the names removed than of the roll.
7. Little has come back. In the 21 states with a final roll, the roll published after claims and objections are heard, the rolls grew back by at most 14.1% of what was cut, and that rise includes new voters.

Two limits. The adult figures count people where they live, so states that draw migrants look short of electors who are registered in their home states. And these figures show what happened. They cannot show why it happened, or that anyone meant it to.

At a glance

13.39 crore	71.5%	21.0%	14.1
left off the draft rolls	shifted, absent or other	dead	removed per 100 electors

The Special Intensive Revision is a fresh check of every name on the electoral rolls, and it has been carried out in three phases. Bihar came first, in 2025, then twelve states and union territories from November 2025, and eighteen more in 2026. In the 31 that have published a draft roll, 13,39,02,054 electors on the rolls before the revision were not carried onto it. That is 14.1 for every 100. Tripura, the last, publishes its draft in December.

Every state gave a reason for most of its removals. Of the 13.28 crore names it split by reason, 2.78 crore (21.0%) were entered as dead, 9.49 crore (71.5%) as shifted, absent or other, and 1.01 crore (7.6%) as enrolled more than once. Deaths are about one in five. The other four in five rest on an officer's entry that the elector was not where the roll placed them, or was on it twice.

A reason is what an officer wrote down after a visit, or after failing to find the elector, and nobody has checked it. The figures cannot say how many entries were wrong.

State by state, on one map

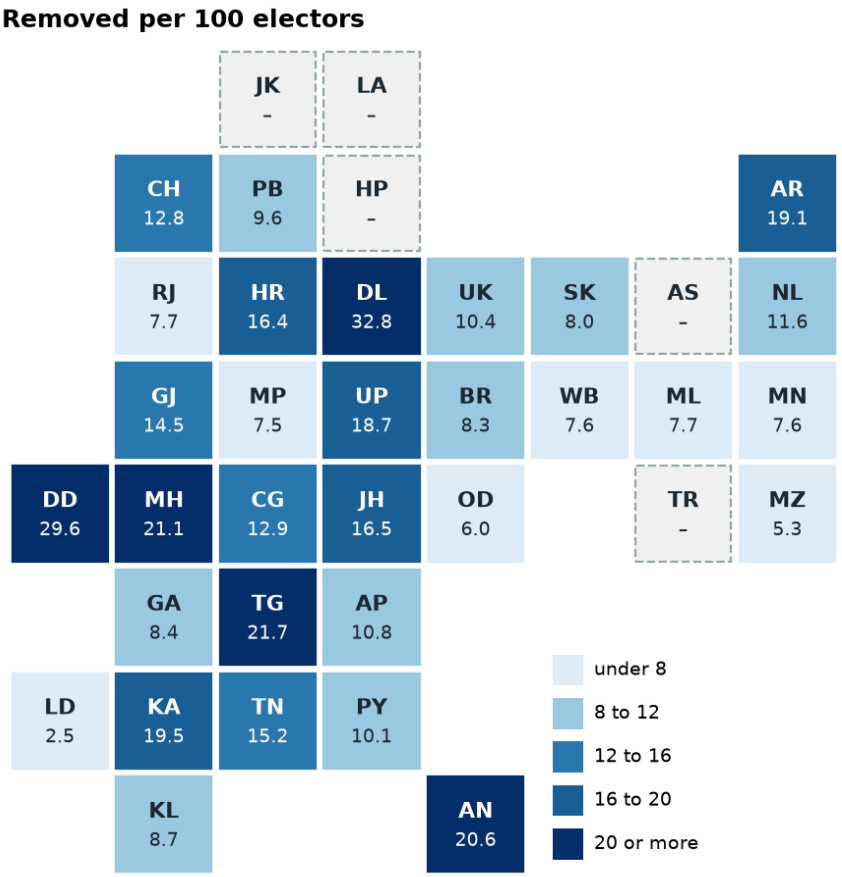


Figure 1. One tile per state or union territory, placed roughly where it lies, so the tiles show no borders. Grey tiles are states not in the revision (Jammu and Kashmir, Ladakh, Himachal Pradesh, Assam), with no draft roll yet (Tripura), or with no exact roll from before it (Chandigarh).

The rolls against the adult population

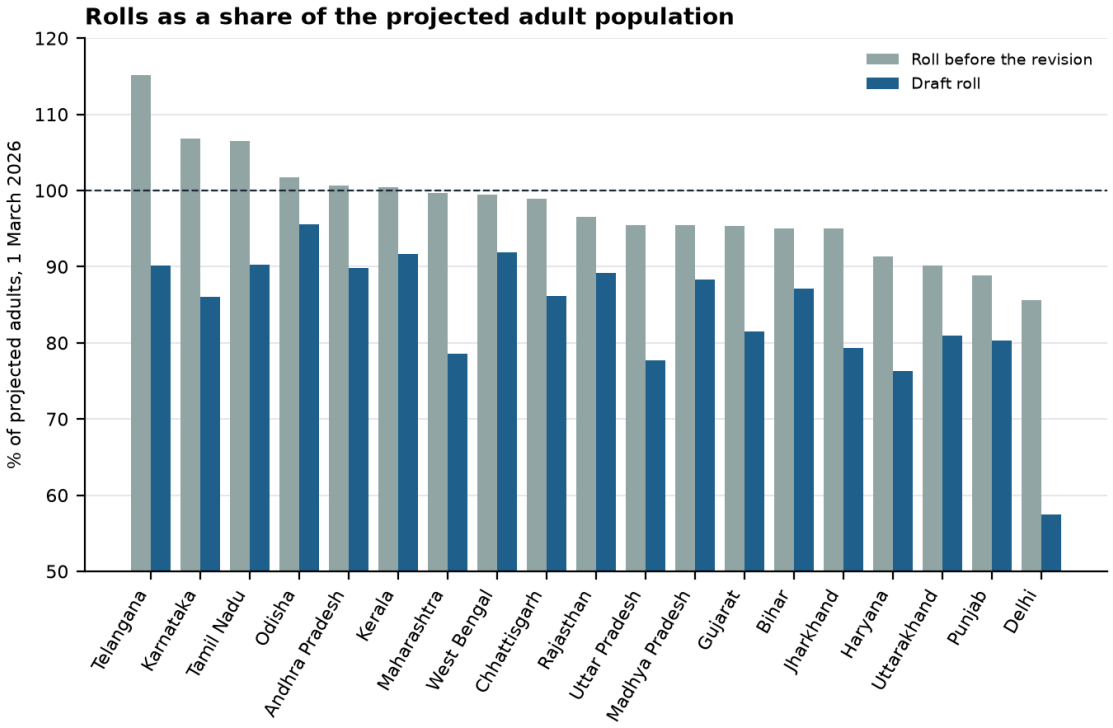


Figure 2. Nineteen states with projections by age. The dashed line is a roll equal to the adult population.

A roll larger than the adult population is what a roll swollen by the dead and the departed would look like, and it is the case the revision was meant to answer. Across the 19 states with projections by age, the rolls before the revision held 98.3% of the projected population aged 18 and over, and the draft rolls hold 84.4%. Only 6 had a roll larger than their adult population (Telangana, Karnataka, Tamil Nadu, Odisha, Andhra Pradesh and Kerala). How far a roll exceeded its adult population has no relationship with how many names the state removed (rank correlation 0.03). A rank correlation runs from -1 to 1 and shows whether states that rank high on one measure also rank high on the other. The lowest draft rolls against the adult population are in Delhi (57.5%), Haryana (76.3%) and Uttar Pradesh (77.7%). The projections count residents, so a state that receives many migrants counts adults who may be registered in their home state, which lowers its ratio.

Set against the 2024 Lok Sabha election, the names left off the draft roll equal a fifth or more of the votes polled in 13 states, led by Delhi (53.2%), Dadra and Nagar Haveli and Daman and Diu (42.6%) and Maharashtra (36.1%).

The three reasons, by phase

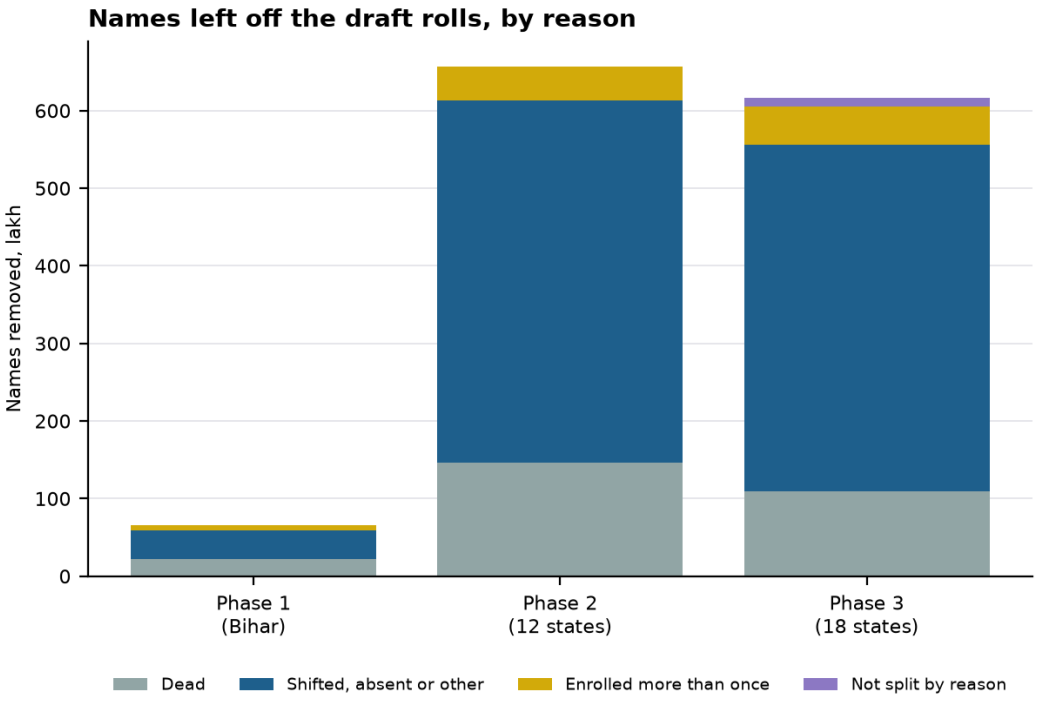


Figure 3. Names left off the draft rolls in each phase, by the reason entered, in lakh.

The share entered as dead fell from 34.0% in Bihar to 22.2% in phase 2 and 18.1% in phase 3, while the share entered as shifted, absent or other rose from 55.3% to 71.0% and 73.7%. Removals per 100 electors rose with each phase, from 8.3 to 12.9 and then 17.0.

State by state

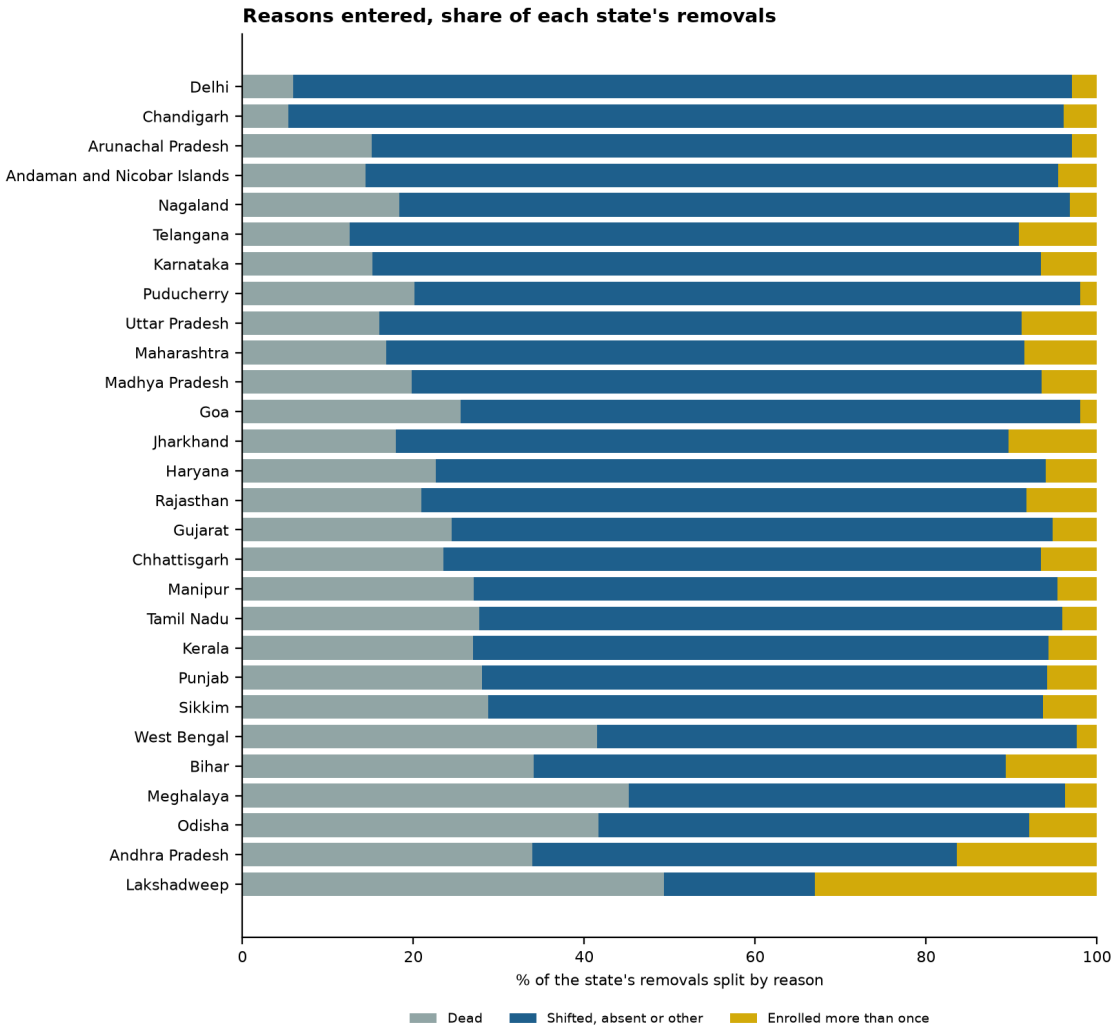


Figure 4. States that published a split by reason, ordered by the share entered as shifted, absent or other.

Among states that removed ten lakh names or more, the share entered as shifted, absent or other runs from 49.7% in Andhra Pradesh to 91.1% in Delhi. Among them the share entered as dead is highest in Odisha (41.7%), and the share entered as enrolled more than once in Andhra Pradesh (16.4%). One revision under one set of instructions produced very different mixes of reasons from state to state, and the Commission has not explained why.

Removals per 100 electors range from 2.5 in Lakshadweep to 32.8 in Delhi. Uttar Pradesh removed the most names in all, 2.89 crore.

State or UT	Phase	Removed	Per 100	Dead	Shifted, absent, other	Duplicate	Split	Figures
Uttar Pradesh	2	2,88,74,067	18.7	46,23,796	2,17,03,064	25,47,207	Full	exact
Maharashtra	3	2,06,88,487	21.1	34,81,000	1,54,55,000	17,63,000	Full	rounded
Karnataka	3	1,07,96,339	19.5	16,39,864	84,46,605	7,09,870	Full	exact
Tamil Nadu	2	97,37,831	15.2	26,94,672	66,44,881	3,98,278	Full	exact
Gujarat	2	73,73,327	14.5	18,07,278	51,84,579	3,81,470	Full	rounded
Telangana	3	73,39,235	21.7	9,22,229	57,46,803	6,70,203	Full	rounded
Bihar	1	65,59,626	8.3	22,32,586	36,25,981	7,01,059	Full	exact
West Bengal	2	58,20,899	7.6	24,16,852	32,65,719	1,38,328	Full	exact

State or UT	Phase	Removed	Per 100	Dead	Shifted, absent, other	Duplicate	Split	Figures
Delhi	3	47,56,722	32.8	2,82,412	43,32,775	1,41,535	Full	exact
Andhra Pradesh	3	44,89,512	10.8	15,22,000	22,30,000	7,37,000	Full	rounded
Jharkhand	3	43,61,987	16.5	7,63,000	30,42,000	4,38,000	Short	rounded
Madhya Pradesh	2	42,74,160	7.5	8,46,000	31,51,000	2,77,000	Full	rounded
Rajasthan	2	41,84,891	7.7	8,75,000	29,60,000	3,44,000	Full	rounded
Haryana	3	33,83,302	16.4	7,66,000	24,13,000	2,04,000	Full	rounded
Chhattisgarh	2	27,34,817	12.9	6,42,234	19,13,540	1,79,043	Full	exact
Kerala	2	24,08,503	8.7	6,49,885	16,22,599	1,36,029	Full	exact
Punjab	3	20,66,635	9.6	5,74,568	13,56,846	1,19,145	Short	exact
Odisha	3	20,12,557	6.0	8,32,544	10,07,454	1,58,118	Short	exact
Uttarakhand	3	8,26,977	10.4	–	–	–	None	exact
Meghalaya	3	1,80,402	7.7	81,490	92,211	6,701	Full	exact
Arunachal Pradesh	3	1,69,459	19.1	25,573	1,38,939	4,947	Full	exact
Manipur	3	1,58,677	7.6	43,000	1,08,283	7,394	Full	exact
Nagaland	3	1,57,752	11.6	28,944	1,23,749	5,059	Full	exact
Dadra and Nagar Haveli and Daman and Diu	3	1,26,894	29.6	–	–	–	None	exact
Puducherry	2	1,03,467	10.1	20,798	80,645	2,024	Full	exact
Goa	2	1,00,042	8.4	25,574	72,471	1,997	Full	exact
Chandigarh	3	66,145	12.8	3,535	60,020	2,590	Full	exact
Andaman and Nicobar Islands	2	64,014	20.6	9,191	51,906	2,917	Full	exact
Mizoram	3	46,162	5.3	–	–	–	None	exact
Sikkim	3	37,737	8.0	10,837	24,504	2,396	Full	exact
Lakshadweep	2	1,429	2.5	705	252	472	Full	exact
Tripura	3	–	–	–	–	–	No draft	–

Under Split, Full means the reasons account for the total within rounding, Short means they leave some names unexplained (Jharkhand, Punjab and Odisha), and None means no split was found (Uttarakhand, Dadra and Nagar Haveli and Daman and Diu and Mizoram). Under Figures, rounded means the state published in lakh or crore (8 states).

Women among the removed

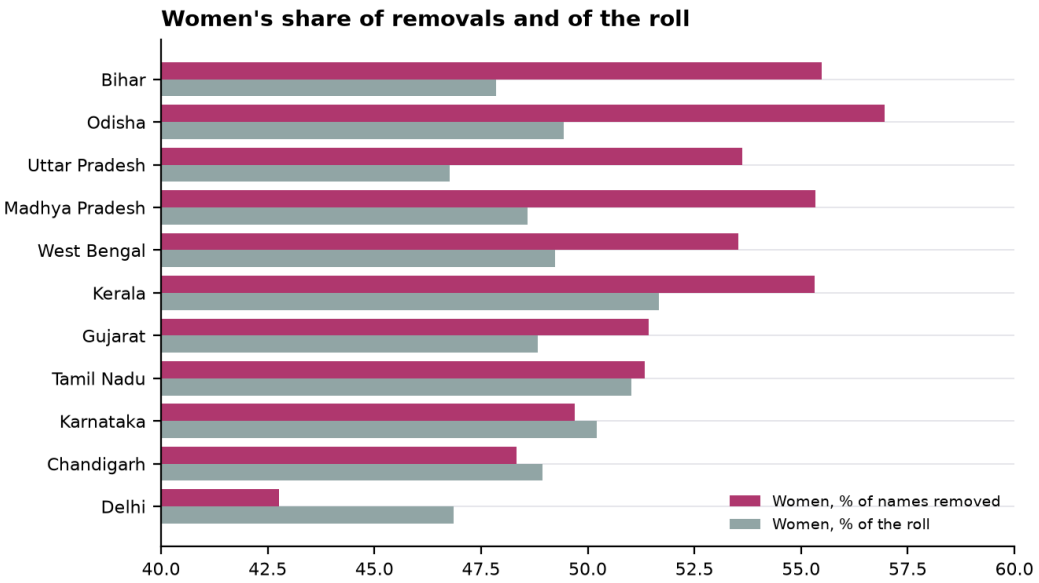


Figure 5. States that published a split by sex. Bihar's roll before the revision is its draft roll plus the names removed at the draft, by sex.

Only ten states have published their removals by sex, or their roll by sex before the revision and on the draft. In 7 of the ten, women are a larger share of the names removed than of the roll, by up to 7.6 points in Bihar. Tamil Nadu, Karnataka and Chandigarh are within a point of even, and Delhi runs the other way, by 4.1 points. Most phase 3 states have published no split by sex, so this is not the national picture.

State	Women removed	Men removed	Women, % removed	Women, % of roll	Difference	Figures
Bihar	36,39,976	29,19,433	55.5	47.9	+7.6	lists
Odisha	11,46,140	8,66,107	57.0	49.4	+7.5	exact
Uttar Pradesh	1,55,00,000	1,34,00,000	53.6	46.8	+6.9	rounded
Madhya Pradesh	23,63,850	19,08,541	55.3	48.6	+6.7	exact
West Bengal	31,16,050	27,04,474	53.5	49.2	+4.3	exact
Kerala	13,10,361	10,58,149	55.3	51.7	+3.6	earlier roll
Gujarat	37,91,000	35,82,000	51.4	48.8	+2.6	rounded
Tamil Nadu	49,90,000	47,30,000	51.3	51.0	+0.3	unverified
Karnataka	53,64,049	54,30,166	49.7	50.2	-0.5	exact
Chandigarh	31,971	34,169	48.3	48.9	-0.6	exact
Delhi	20,34,005	27,22,139	42.8	46.9	-4.1	exact

What goes with the removal rate

Each state's removals per 100 electors, and the shares of its removals entered as dead or as enrolled more than once, are set against its characteristics as rank correlations across states. A value of 1 means the two rise together, 0 means no relationship, and anything under 0.2 either way is read as none. The number of states in each is in brackets.

Characteristic	Rate, all states	Rate, phase 2	Rate, phase 3	Share dead	Share twice, larger states
Share of residents born in another state (Census 2011)	0.51 (29)	0.04 (12)	0.62 (16)	-0.51 (26)	-0.26 (16)
Income per head (RBI, 2023-24)	0.38 (29)	0.17 (11)	0.47 (17)	-0.31 (27)	-0.39 (18)
Urban spending per head (HCES 2023-24)	0.26 (31)	0.28 (12)	0.15 (18)	-0.39 (28)	-0.32 (18)
SC share of households (NFHS-5, 2019-21 (households))	0.19 (31)	0.01 (12)	0.37 (18)	-0.07 (28)	-0.15 (18)
Urban share (Technical Group projection, 2026)	0.09 (30)	-0.24 (12)	0.30 (17)	-0.20 (28)	-0.57 (18)
Muslim share of households (NFHS-5, 2019-21 (households))	0.09 (31)	-0.27 (12)	0.46 (18)	-0.03 (28)	-0.02 (18)
Rural spending per head (HCES 2023-24)	0.07 (31)	0.09 (12)	0.06 (18)	-0.20 (28)	-0.34 (18)
Share born here but living in another state (Census 2011)	0.03 (29)	-0.30 (12)	0.29 (16)	-0.11 (26)	0.24 (16)
Literacy (PLFS 2023-24)	-0.11 (31)	-0.04 (12)	-0.20 (18)	0.02 (28)	-0.68 (18)
Women's literacy (PLFS 2023-24)	-0.14 (31)	-0.10 (12)	-0.20 (18)	0.05 (28)	-0.70 (18)
ST share of households (NFHS-5, 2019-21 (households))	-0.26 (31)	-0.45 (12)	-0.26 (18)	0.22 (28)	0.27 (18)
Sex ratio (NFHS-5, 2019-21)	-0.46 (31)	-0.36 (12)	-0.46 (18)	0.51 (28)	0.28 (18)

Across all states the removal rate goes most with the share of residents born in another state (0.51), and that comes from phase 3 (0.62). In phase 2 it is 0.04. In phase 3, income per head, Muslim share of households, sex ratio and share of residents born in another state all go with the removal rate, because the big states that draw migrants were revised in the same phase as the North-East, and they differ from it on all of these at once. With only 16 states in the phase, there is no telling these apart. The only characteristics that go with the removal rate the same way in both phases are ST share of households (-0.45 in phase 2, -0.26 in phase 3) and sex ratio (-0.36 in phase 2, -0.46 in phase 3). The Muslim share of households has no consistent relationship, 0.09 across all states, -0.27 in phase 2 and 0.46 in phase 3. Among the larger states, the share entered as enrolled more than once goes most with women's literacy (-0.70). Migration is from the 2011 census because no newer figure is published by state, and every other characteristic is from 2019 to 2026. Run on the 2011 census values instead, the reading changes only for urban share.

States on an international border removed fewer names than interior states. The typical border state removed 8.3 per 100 electors across 13 states, and the typical interior state 14.0 across 18. None of these relationships says who was removed inside a state, because a pattern across states tells us nothing about individuals.

After the final rolls

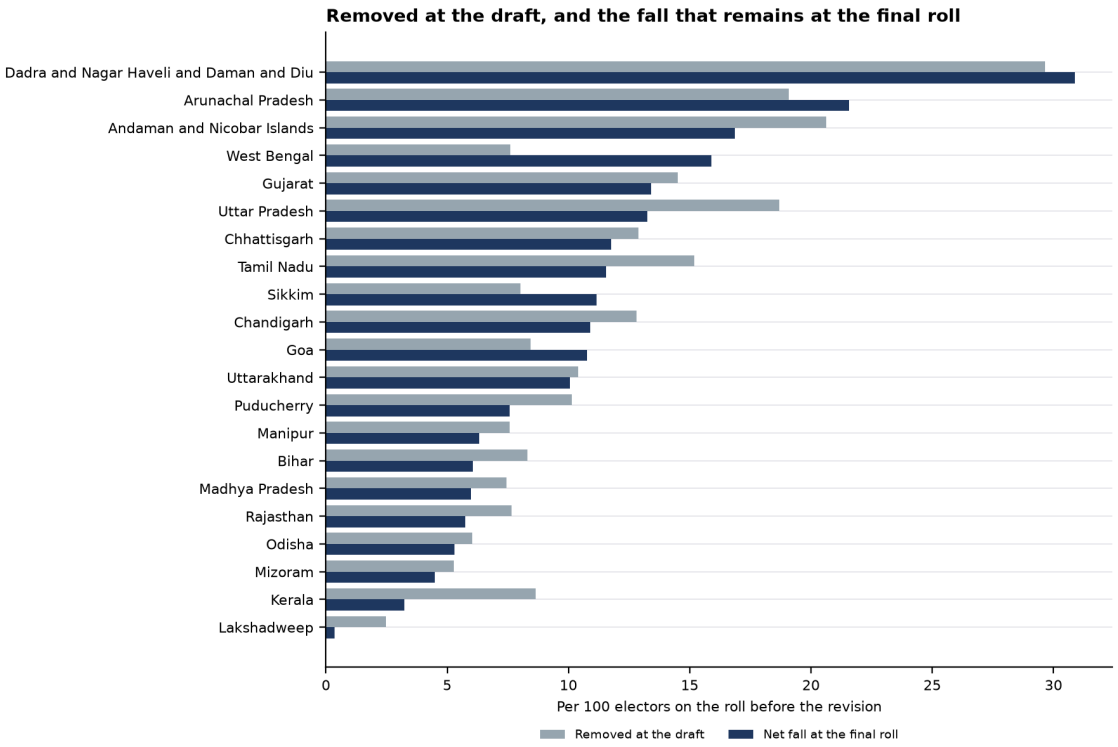


Figure 6. States whose final roll is out and whose roll before the revision was published exactly enough to set against it.

In the 21 states and union territories with a final roll, 7.57 crore names were left off the drafts, and the final rolls came out 1.07 crore larger than the drafts, which is 14.1% of the fall. West Bengal kept 60.1 lakh names off its final roll while they are decided, and without them the final rolls were 1.67 crore larger, 22.0% of the fall. The net fall is the roll before the revision less the final roll. It comes to 10.2 per 100 electors, against 11.9 left off at the draft.

The rise from draft to final counts new electors as well as names put back, and no state has said how many of those added had been removed at the draft, so it is the most that can have been put back. The final roll is smaller than the draft in 5 states (West Bengal, Goa, Arunachal Pradesh, Dadra and Nagar Haveli and Daman and Diu and Sikkim). How many names a state removed at the draft has no relationship with how much of that its final roll made up (rank correlation -0.15).

State or UT	Removed at draft	Added after	Removed after	Final less draft	Made up	Net fall per 100	Figures
Uttar Pradesh	2,88,74,067	–	8,15,996	84,28,767	29.2%	13.2	Net only
Tamil Nadu	97,37,831	27,53,000	4,23,000	23,30,624	23.9%	11.6	Rounded
Gujarat	73,73,327	–	–	5,60,616	7.6%	13.4	Net only
Bihar	65,59,626	21,53,343	3,66,742	17,86,601	27.2%	6.0	Adds up
West Bengal	58,20,899	1,88,707	5,46,053	−63,64,021	-109.3%	15.9	Adds up
Madhya Pradesh	42,74,160	–	–	8,49,082	19.9%	6.0	Net only
Rajasthan	41,84,891	12,91,365	2,42,760	10,48,605	25.1%	5.7	Adds up
Chhattisgarh	27,34,817	–	–	2,34,994	8.6%	11.8	Net only
Kerala	24,08,503	15,11,292	53,229	15,11,292	62.7%	3.2	Does not add up
Odisha	20,12,557	2,90,497	44,777	2,45,720	12.2%	5.3	Adds up
Uttarakhand	8,26,977	1,29,872	1,04,708	25,164	3.0%	10.1	Adds up

State or UT	Removed at draft	Added after	Removed after	Final less draft	Made up	Net fall per 100	Figures
Arunachal Pradesh	1,69,459	8,803	30,823	−22,020	-13.0%	21.6	Adds up
Manipur	1,58,677	56,871	30,650	26,221	16.5%	6.3	Adds up
Dadra and Nagar Haveli and Daman and Diu	1,26,894	–	–	−5,309	-4.2%	30.9	Net only
Puducherry	1,03,467	41,492	16,619	26,100	25.2%	7.6	Does not add up
Goa	1,00,042	12,166	39,592	−27,426	-27.4%	10.8	Adds up
Chandigarh	66,145	15,117	5,190	9,927	15.0%	10.9	Adds up
Andaman and Nicobar Islands	64,014	16,919	5,269	11,650	18.2%	16.9	Adds up
Mizoram	46,162	39,243	32,280	6,963	15.1%	4.5	Adds up
Sikkim	37,737	1,982	16,809	−14,827	-39.3%	11.2	Adds up
Lakshadweep	1,429	1,270	47	1,223	85.6%	0.4	Adds up

Under Figures, adds up means the draft plus additions less removals equals the final roll, net only means the state published the draft and final rolls but not the additions and removals behind the difference, and does not add up means the published figures do not match (Kerala and Puducherry). Removals after the draft carry no reason in any state except Bihar, so they are outside every figure by reason in this report. Maharashtra, Karnataka, Telangana, Delhi, Andhra Pradesh, Jharkhand, Haryana, Punjab, Meghalaya and Nagaland have not yet published a final roll.

Against the winning margins

A seat is decided by the votes between its winner and its runner-up. Where more names left a seat's roll than that margin, the names removed were enough to decide the seat. Whether they did depends on how those people would have voted, and that can be estimated only where the lists say who they were.

State	Election	Seats	Count larger than the margin	What is counted
Bihar	2025	243	174 (71.6%)	names removed, both phases
Tamil Nadu	2026	234	211 (90.2%)	names removed
West Bengal	2026	294	139 (47.3%)	fall in the roll from 2024 to the 2026 election
Kerala	2026	140	38 (27.1%)	fall in the roll from January 2025 to the 2026 election

In Bihar and Tamil Nadu, where the names removed are counted seat by seat, they were more than the winning margin in 385 of 477 assembly seats. West Bengal and Kerala publish no removals by seat, so their count is the fall in the roll, which also takes in ordinary deaths and moves, and it was more than the margin in 177 of 434. The two are kept apart because they count different things.

Bihar is the one state whose lists show who was removed. Estimating how they would have voted from their own booths in 2024, 4 to 6 seats would have changed hands, in both directions, and on every estimate the NDA keeps a majority, with 200 to 204 of 243 seats.

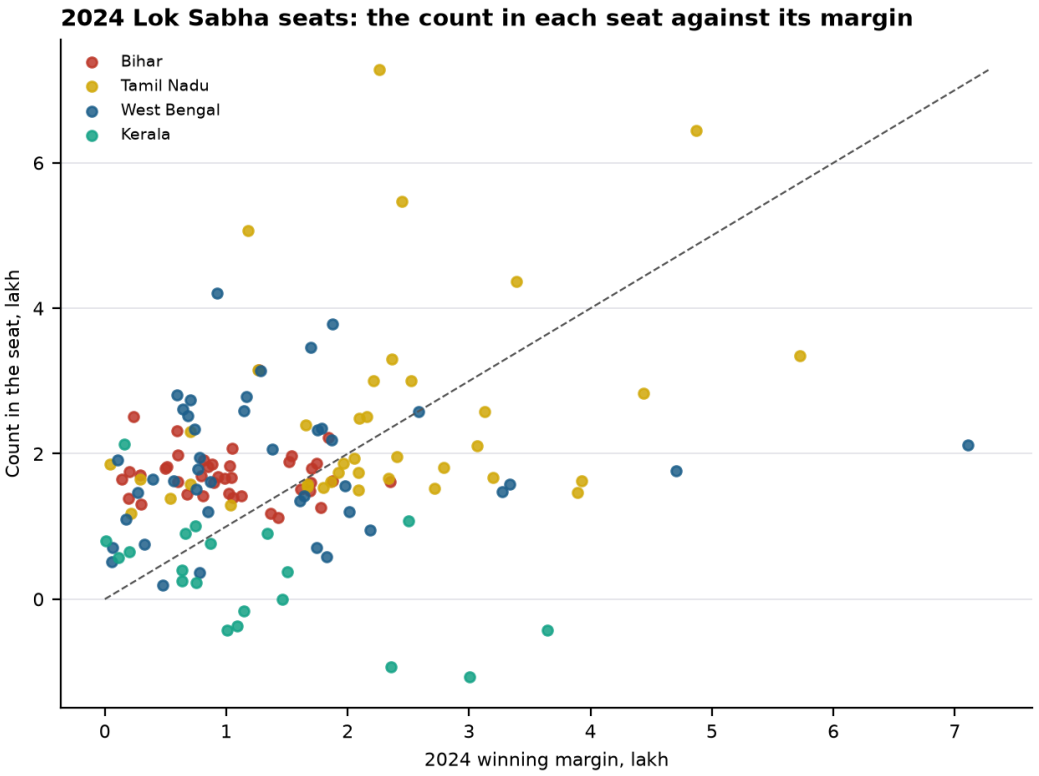


Figure 7. Each dot is a 2024 Lok Sabha seat in the four states, its count added up from its assembly segments. Above the dashed line, the count is larger than the margin. Below zero are Kerala seats whose roll grew.

Set against the 2024 Lok Sabha results, the count in each seat was larger than the margin in 51 of 79 seats in Bihar and Tamil Nadu and 34 of 62 in West Bengal and Kerala. The revision came after the 2024 election, so this measures how large the removals are against the votes that decide a seat, and it does not say what happened in 2024.

No state has published its removals by Lok Sabha seat. Spread evenly over each state's seats, the removals would be larger than the 2024 margin in 373 of 516 seats in 31 states and union territories. Where seat counts exist the even spread can be tested. In Bihar it gives 32 seats against 32 counted, and in Tamil Nadu 27 against 19, because removals there were heaviest in the cities and most seats lost fewer names than the state average. It is a rough guide that can run high. In 2024, 115 of 542 contested seats were won by fewer than 50,000 votes.

The roll over forty years

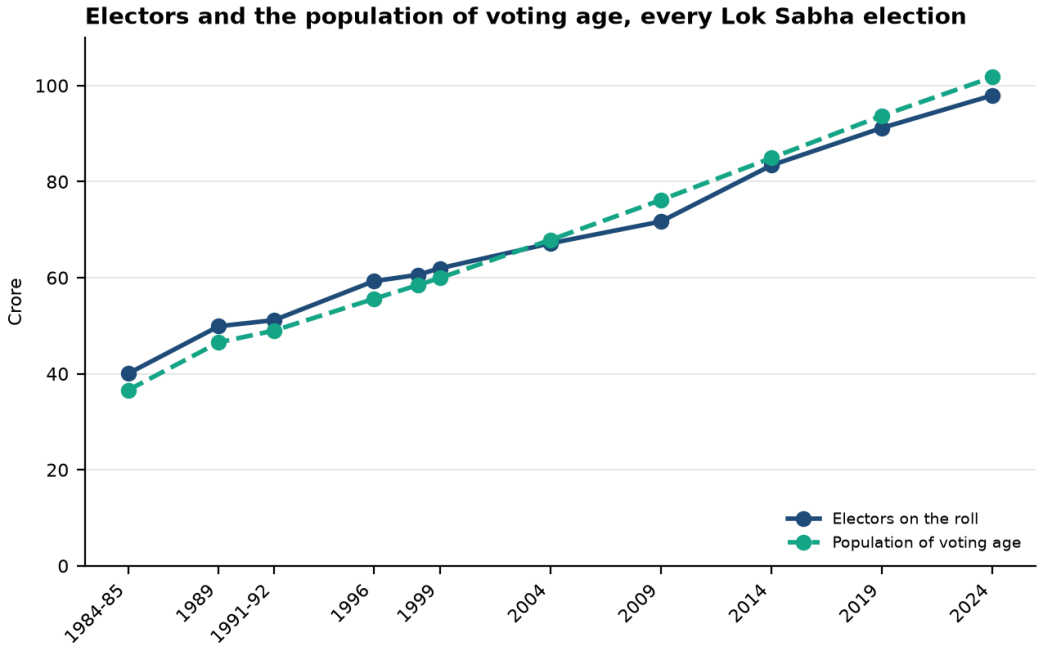


Figure 8. Electors from the Election Commission's Atlas 2024 (Graph 6.1). Population of voting age, 21 and over in 1984-85 and 18 and over from 1989, from the UN World Population Prospects 2024, a modelled estimate that counts everyone living in India, citizens or not.

The roll grew from 40.04 crore in 1984-85 to 97.98 crore in 2024. In every election to 1999 it held more names than there were people of voting age, up to 109.5 for every 100 in 1984-85. If the population estimate is right, a roll that large carried the names of people who had died or moved, or counted some people twice. From 2004 it has held fewer, 96 for every 100 in 2024. Some of that gap is people who are not citizens, whom the population counts and the roll cannot.

In the ten years from 2014 to 2024 the roll gained 14.57 crore. The 13.39 crore names left off the draft rolls are 92 in every 100 of that gain, though the two are not strictly alike, because the revision covered 31 states and union territories and the Lok Sabha figure is all India.

How the revision was run

The rules changed while the revision was under way. The site's page on how the revision was run lists 33 orders, letters and judgments in date order, 11 of them from the Supreme Court, each linked to its document, and draws every state's schedule as it was set and as it was moved. Across 32 states and union territories, dates were changed 29 times in the orders and notes that could be read.

What made it harder to stay on the roll, each point resting on an order or a judgment:

1. A fresh form from every elector. Only electors whose enumeration forms came back were put on the draft roll. The enumeration form was a fresh form each elector on the roll had to fill in and return. The draft roll was the roll published from those forms, open to claims to add names and objections to names on it before the final roll. A name on the roll for years was left off the draft if its form did not come back in time, and its owner then had to ask to be put back.
2. Parents' documents, by year of birth. In Bihar the younger the elector, the more documents were needed. Anyone born after 2 December 2004 needed documents for themselves and for both parents, and a parent's passport and visa if a parent was not Indian.

3. Aadhaar only on the Court's order. Aadhaar was not on the first list of eleven documents. Claims could carry it from mid-August 2025, as the Commission agreed before the Supreme Court. It became the twelfth document on the Court's order of 8 September 2025, as proof of identity.
4. The declaration changed twice. Form 6, the application to be added to the roll, carried a new declaration from June 2025, a different one from October 2025, and a shorter list of documents from May 2026. No Gazette notification could be found amending the forms of the Registration of Electors Rules, 1960 to match.
5. Dates moved after they were set. All twelve Phase II states and union territories had their dates moved by a week, and seven were moved again. In Phase III, the orders and notes read for this page show dates moved in six of nineteen. An elector working to one deadline could find it had changed.
6. Anyone could object to anyone. Form 7 is the form for objecting to a name on the roll. A person who was not an elector of the constituency could object to a name on oath, a party agent could file ten forms a day after the draft, and Form 7 sets no limit on how many one person may file. In Bihar, objections to names on the roll outnumbered claims to be included by about six to one at the deadline.
7. Notices for logical discrepancies. People flagged for logical discrepancies, where something in their link to the old roll did not match, were called to hearings. The Supreme Court had to order that a representative could file for them and that they get ten more days. Only from September 2026 would booth officers collect their documents at home.
8. Sixty lakh held back in West Bengal. West Bengal's final roll left out 60,06,675 names marked under adjudication. They waited on judicial officers and then on nineteen tribunals, and a pending appeal gave no right to vote.
9. Few came back after the draft. In the states that published both counts, the names added after the draft, new electors included, fell well short of the names removed at it. In three of them fewer than 10 were added for every 100 removed.

The page also lists 33 press reports of problems in the field, each attributed to its outlet and kept apart from the points above because no document confirms them.

What the Election Commission should do

13.39 crore names came off the draft rolls, about four in five of them on an entry that the elector had moved, could not be found, or was on the roll twice. The Election Commission should:

1. Publish a state-by-state table of its own, in exact figures, with the reason for every removal at the draft and after it.
2. Publish the deletion lists with the reason against each name for every state, as it did for Bihar, so that removals can be counted by booth, sex and age.
3. Publish the basis for entries marked absent and enrolled more than once.
4. Publish the outcome of every claim and objection, and say how many of those added at the final roll had been removed at the draft, so that restorations can be set against removals.
5. Explain why the mix of reasons differs so widely between states under one set of instructions.

Method and sources

Each state's Chief Electoral Officer, the Election Commission's officer in charge of its rolls, published figures when the draft roll came out, and the All India figures are those officers' own. They are taken

from the press notes where those could be read (Uttar Pradesh, Tamil Nadu, West Bengal, Rajasthan, Lakshadweep, Karnataka, Uttarakhand, Meghalaya, Arunachal Pradesh, Manipur and Nagaland) and from press reports otherwise. Bihar's row is counted from the deletion lists. The reasons are grouped into the three every state reported. The state rows add up to 13.39 crore removed, against the about 13.3 crore reported nationally on 30 September 2026, and the difference is rounding. Each row's source is listed on the method page of the site and in the downloadable table.

No name, EPIC number or address is published.